2.1.1 Physiological Functions of Food

- Satisfies hunger and increases satiety value.
- Helps in maintaining normal secretion of enzymes and hormones.
- Supplies nutrients that are needed for physical growth and development, maintenance of normal body functions, physical activity and health.



▲ Plate 2.1 Functions of food

a. Energy Yielding Foods: They provide energy to perform voluntary and involuntary processes in the body. The energy needed is supplied by oxidation of foods consumed.



▲ Plate 2.2 Energy Yielding Foods

Cereals, millets, roots and tubers, fruits like banana, dried fruits, sugar and jaggery, oil, butter and ghee are energy yielding foods.

b. Body-Building Foods: Foods rich in protein are called body building foods.

Milk, egg, meat, fish contain protein of high biological value. These foods have all the essential amino acids in correct proportion for the synthesis of body tissues.

Foods like pulses, oilseeds and nuts contain protein but may not contain all the essential amino acids required for the human body.



▲ Plate 2.3 Body Building Foods

c. Protective and Regulatory Foods: Foods rich in vitamins and minerals have regulatory functions in the body e.g., maintaining the heart beat, water balance, temperature. Protective foods prevent diseases as they are rich in antioxidants.

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